The past continuous · when / while · used to: side by side

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red: Additional exercise **14** (page 257, past simple and past continuous) in class. At home: Unit 98 (page 207): **98.2** and Unit 105 (page 221): **105.2**. (Unit 98: 98.3 is next to the future: Week 15.)
This week there is no new grammar. This file puts the three together.

1 · Three tenses for three jobs

was / were + -ing = the scene, an action in progress: *It **was snowing**. He **was walking**.*
past simple = the events: *Suddenly he **heard** a voice.*
used to = the old habit: *He **used to** tell this story every winter.*

2 · when / while / as

while + long action: *While I **was sleeping**, the phone rang.*
when + short action: *I was sleeping **when** the phone rang.*
as = while: *As he was walking, he saw a light.*
Two long actions: *While Mom was cooking, I was doing my homework.*

3 · Not for one time

✗ Last night I ~~used to see~~ a ghost → ✓ I **saw** a ghost.
✗ I ~~was knowing~~ the answer → ✓ I **knew** the answer. (know, like, want: no -ing)

4 · A story in three steps

1 Scene: *It was a cold night. The snow was falling.* **2** Event: *Suddenly the dog barked.* **3** Result: *We followed the light and walked home.*

Use this order and your story sounds natural.

5 · The Russian trap

«Когда я шёл домой, пошёл снег» → *When I **was walking** home, it **began** to snow.*
«Раньше я боялся» → *I **used to** be afraid.* «Вчера я боялся» → *Yesterday I **was** afraid.*

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Choose the correct form

1. I (saw / was seeing) a ghost while I (walked / was walking) home.
2. When I was small, I (used to be / was being) afraid of the dark.
3. She (cooked / was cooking) when the lights (went / were going) out.
4. We (didn't hear / weren't hearing) the noise because we (slept / were sleeping).
5. At eight o'clock last night I (did / was doing) my homework.
6. My grandfather (used to tell / was telling) us stories every winter.
7. It (rained / was raining) when we left.
8. (Did you use to / Were you using to) have a pet?

2 Finish the story with a verb: past continuous, past simple or used to

1. It was a stormy night. The wind (blow) ____.
2. My grandfather (walk) ____ home when he (see) ____ a light.
3. As a child, he (be) ____ afraid of storms, but now he is not.
4. While he (wait) ____, the dog (bark) ____.
5. He (not / reach) ____ the village that night.
6. Years ago people (use to / tell) ____ ghost stories by the fire.

3 Translate into English

1. Когда я шёл домой, я увидел свет.

2. Пока он спал, начался дождь.

3. Раньше мы жили в горах.

4. Что ты делал в девять вечера?

5. Вчера была ужасная погода.

6. Они не слышали голоса, потому что слушали музыку.

7. Раньше он не любил зиму.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Look at the picture and tell the story



Write a story of 8 sentences about the picture: the scene (was / were + -ing), the events (past simple), one sentence with used to.

5 Complete the story

When I (1 be) _____ a child, we (2 use to / live) _____ in a small village. One night a storm (3 come) _____. Mom (4 cook) _____ dinner when the lights (5 go) _____ out. We (6 not / be) _____ afraid, because Dad (7 tell) _____ us a ghost story by the fire. While he (8 talk) _____, we (9 hear) _____ a noise. It (10 be) _____ only the wind!

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 saw, was walking · used to be · was cooking, went · didn’t hear, were sleeping · was doing · used to tell · was raining · Did you use to

2 was blowing · was walking, saw · used to be (was) · was waiting, barked · didn’t reach · used to tell

3 When I was walking home, I saw a light. · While he was sleeping, it began to rain. · We used to live in the mountains. · What were you doing at nine in the evening? · The weather was terrible yesterday. · They didn’t hear a voice, because they were listening to music. · He didn’t use to like winter.

4 Own answers.

5 was · used to live · came · was cooking · went · weren’t · told (was telling) · was talking · heard · was